challenge the state's authority, respond swiftly—within 48 hours."

The messaging is not confined to rhetoric. Overall, there have been a dozen police encounters involving alleged criminals, with police firing killing two people and injuring the others. On April 29, within hours of the murder of Bihar Administrative Service officer Krishna Bhushan Kumar in Bhagalpur, police identified the alleged mastermind, who was later killed in an encounter. Days later, on May 3, another alleged criminal was gunned down in the same manner in Siwan.

District officials speak of late-night follow-up calls from the top. Police officers are pressured for quick results. On May 14, after a spice trader was shot dead in Patna, officials say, Choudhary made seven phone calls to top officers through the night, pressing for immediate results. Within two days, a juvenile contract killer was arrested in connection with the murder.

During this period, a major social-policing initiative—the Police Didi Scheme—has also been launched, under which women police personnel will be stationed near educational institutions to prevent crimes against women. "I have given the Bihar Police a free hand," Choudhary said on May 18. "No one should dare take the law into their own hands, and the police are continuously responding firmly to such challenges."

GOVERNANCE PUSH

Beyond restoring law and order, the Samrat Choudhary government's agenda ranges from ambitious urban planning and education spending to grievance redressal and administrative reform.

One of the most ambitious initiatives is the blueprint for 11 satellite townships across 10 districts—envisioned as planned urban spaces, with residential colonies, commercial zones, wide roads and green belts lined with plantations and public parks.

The government has also rolled out Sahyog ki Triveni, a three-tier public grievance and accountability system to address complaints related to block offices, police stations and revenue departments. Importantly, the government has imposed a strict 30-day deadline for resolving complaints, warning officials of disciplinary action, including suspension, for delays.

In the education sector, the government has attempted to push both infrastructure expansion and institutional reform. It has approved Rs 800 crore to convert all district schools and one selected higher secondary school in every block into 'Model Schools'. Besides, Rs 104 crore has been sanctioned to establish degree colleges in 208 blocks that currently lack one, a move expected to create more than 9,000 new positions.

Another politically significant decision has been the amendment to the Bihar Public Works Code, giving preference to Bihar-based contractors for civil

IN MISSION MODE

How the new CM is pushing fast and visible action on the ground

- Governance approach is built around decisive outcomes
- Meetings are shorter, sharper and politically charged
- Late-night calls to officers, direct monitoring and pressure for quick delivery
- Police given operational freedom; '48-hour response' doctrine
- Policing, inspections, announcements and crackdowns all widely amplified
- AI-based scrutiny of engineering estimates introduced to target inflated costing and institutional corruption
- Key Nitish-era officers replaced with a trusted administrative network in the CM secretariat
- Heavy reliance on symbolism and projection of authority through saffron imagery, muscular rhetoric and an interventionist posture
- Governance is now a 'mission mode' political campaign



"I have given the Bihar Police a free hand. No one should dare take the law into their own hands"

"Once AI becomes integrated into governance, duplication and inflated projections will disappear"

SAMRAT CHOUDHARY, *Chief Minister, Bihar*